5/10/25

For Anne Gregory
-William Butler Yeats

I Answer the following Reference to Context:-

1 "Never ---------- hair"

a whom are these lines addressed to?
Ans These lines are addressed to Anne.

b what do the young men love the lady for?
Ans Young men love the lady for her external beauty, especially her yellow hair, not for her inner qualities.

c which poetic device is used for the phrase 'Honey coloured Rampart'?
Ans Metaphor

d The antonym of the word despair is
(i) hatred (iii) hesitation
(ii) hope (✓) (iv) habit

II Answer the following Short Answers:-

~~Anne and the speaker~~

Q1 Between whom does the conversation in the poem take place?
Ans The conversation in the poem 'For Anne Gregory' takes place between Anne and a thoughtful speaker, possibly the poet himself. They discuss the nature of love, where the speaker claims that young men love Anne for her physical beauty, while Anne hopes to be loved for her inner qualities and true self.

Q2 Why do young men love Anne for her hair and not for herself alone?
Ans Young men love Anne for her yellow hair because it symbolizes her physical beauty. They are attracted to her outward appearance rather than her inner qualities, showing how superficial love can be. The poem criticizes this kind of love and highlights Anne's desire to be valued for who she truly is.

Q3 What was not liked by the young men?
Ans The young men did not like Anne Gregory for herself alone - her inner qualities or true personality. They were more attracted to her physical beauty, especially her yellow hair. This shows their superficial nature, as they valued appearance over depth, ignoring the essence of who she truly was a person.

Q4 What is the central idea of the poem 'For Anne Gregory'?
Ans The central idea of 'For Anne Gregory' is that love based on physical appearance is shallow and unreliable. The poem emphasizes the importance of inner beauty and true character. Anne wishes to be loved for who

she truly is, not just for her outward features like her yellow hair, highlighting the difference between superficial attraction and genuine affection.

III Answer the following Long answers:-

Q1 The poet in the poem convaise that we should give importance to the inner beauty and not to the physical appearance. Ellaborate with reference to the poem.

Ans The poet argues that true love must value inner qualities rather than outward looks. In the poem the speaker points out that young men admire Anne for her yellow hair and beauty, not for her character. The speaker uses direct contrast - The men's shallow praise versus Anne's quiet wish - to show that physical attractiveness is an unreliable basis for lasting affection.

The poem reinforces this theme through examples and tone. The speaker describes how the young men "love her for her hair", suggesting their love is linked to a single visible trait. Anne's response - That she would rather be loved "for herself" - serves as a moral counterpoint. The poet's ironic, almost reproachful voice exposes the hollowness of admiration based solely on appearance and elevates Anne's desire to be appreciated for heart, thought, and personality.

Ultimately the poem insist that inner beauty is the foundation of genuine relationships. By juxtaposing fleeting physical admiration with the deeper longing to be known and loved as a whole person, the poet makes a clear moral claim: society should cultivate respect for character and sincerety, and individuals should seek and offer love that recognizes a person's true self rather than surface charm.